VS-07 Governance and Compliance

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VS-07.0 Governance and Compliance

Purpose and Scope

VS-07.0 makes sure that every process, dataset, and product in the organization operates under clear rules, standards, and accountability. It builds trust — inside and outside the NSI — by ensuring all data activities are ethical, transparent, and compliant with legal, methodological, and quality requirements, aligned with standards such as the **European Statistics Code of Practice, GDPR, GSBPM, GAMSO, and ISO** data-quality principles. The value it creates is **integrity and accountability**.

This document covers the business layer only: the governance capabilities, how they are established and operated, and how they interact with the rest of the value chain. The specific application and technology controls that implement them are out of scope (provided with VS-09).

A note on numbering: each `VS-0x.y` below is both a value stream stage (*what value* is added) and a business process (*how* it is done); the numbering maps one-to-one. See the key-concepts box above.

Position — a supporting stream that works across the whole chain

VS-07 is not a stage in the production line. It runs **horizontally** across all six primary streams, setting the rules they must follow and collecting the evidence that they do.

> ! How a supporting value stream differs from a primary one
>
> - **No steady-state data transition.** VS-07 does not take data from one steady state to the next; it does not appear in the #1→#6 chain. It oversees the streams that do.
> - **It runs continuously**, not per production cycle — there is no "Data Registered" event that triggers it.

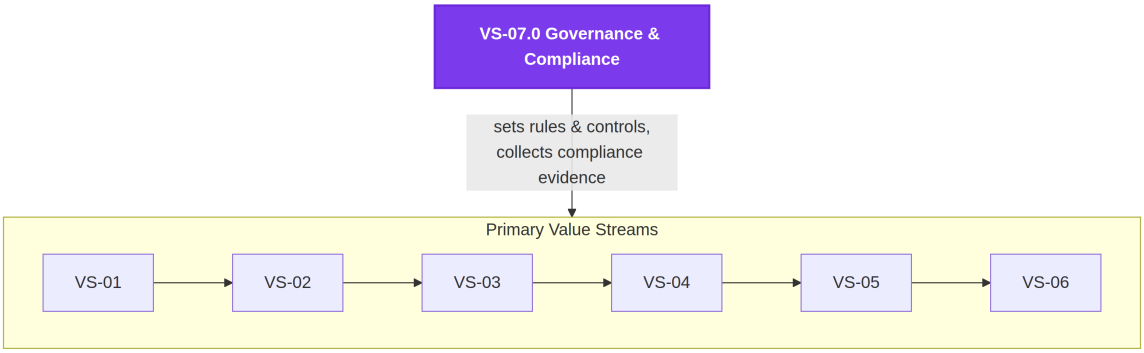


Figure 1: VS-07 governs the whole primary value chain horizontally; it is not a step within it.

- **Its output is an enabling capability, not a data artefact:** governance frameworks, compliance mechanisms, assurance, and audit results.
- **It aligns to GAMSO** (the over-arching activity model) rather than to GSBPM production phases.

How It Interacts with the Production Chain

VS-07 interacts with every other stream in two directions: **downward** it imposes governance frameworks, policies, and controls; **upward** it receives compliance evidence, quality indicators, and audit findings. The primary streams' own audit-and-compliance reporting (their §6.4) feeds directly into VS-07.

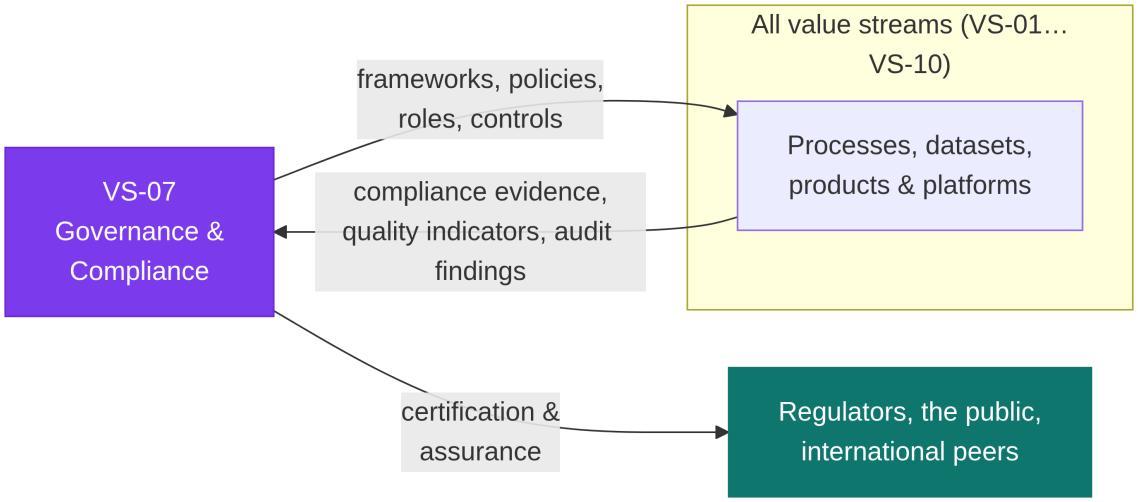


Figure 2: Interaction with the chain: VS-07 sets controls and consumes evidence across the chain, and provides external assurance.

Framework Alignment (GAMSO)

Where the primary streams map to **GSBPM** production phases, VS-07 maps to the **GAMSO** over-arching activities and the **Governance** capability domain of the SAF:

GAMSO area	Relevance to VS-07
Strategy and Leadership	Set governance strategy, charters, and accountability; manage organizational and ethical frameworks

GAMSO area	Relevance to VS-07
Corporate Support	Manage the legal framework, quality management, and information security governance
Capability Management	Govern the lifecycle of standards, methods, and data assets
SAF capability domain: Governance (4.x)	Strategy & governance, policy & planning, improvement management, accountability

Principles Emphasised

VS-07 is the stream that **enforces the data principles across the whole chain** and embodies several of the broader architecture principles:

Principle	Statement	How VS-07 applies / enforces it
SAF-P09	No data without metadata and classification	Governs metadata and classification obligations and audits them across every stream
SAF-P10	Security By Design	Sets and assures the information-security and access-control framework
SAF-P11	Privacy By Design	Sets the privacy, confidentiality, and disclosure-control policy and verifies compliance
SAF-P03	Active Life Cycle management	Governs the lifecycle of policies, standards, classifications, and data assets
SAF-P04	Maximize the benefits for the organization	Aligns controls to organizational value and accountability, avoiding governance for its own sake
SAF-P07	Implement loosely coupled processes and systems	Defines the steady-state interface and event conventions the streams are governed by

Roles and Actors

Role	Description
Chief Data / Governance Officer	Accountable for the governance framework and organizational data policy
Compliance Officer	Ensures legal and regulatory compliance (Code of Practice, GDPR, statistics law)
Data Owner / Steward / Custodian	The data-governance roles VS-07 defines and assigns across domains
Quality Manager	Defines quality indicators and monitors quality and compliance status
Internal / External Auditor	Conducts audits and certifications of adherence to the frameworks
Legal Counsel	Interprets regulation and frames compliance procedures
Process Owners (VS-01...VS-10)	Accountable, in their own streams, for operating within VS-07's controls and supplying evidence

The Value-Stream Flow

VS-07's six business processes form a continuous governance loop — **plan → build → operate → improve** — that never stops running.

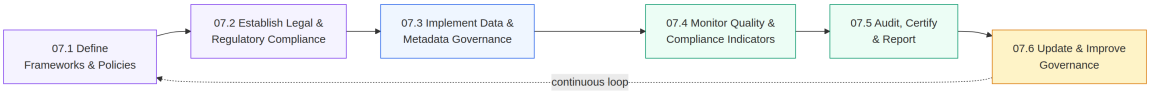


Figure 3: The six business processes as a continuous governance loop.

> **Model note**
>
> The strategy model labels two steps `VS-07.5`. They are distinct activities; this document treats them as **VS-07.5 Audit, Certify, and Report Compliance** and **VS-07.6 Update and Improve Governance Mechanisms**.

Plan — establish the rules. The loop begins by **defining governance frameworks and policies** (07.1): the overarching charters and principles covering data, metadata, ethics, confidentiality, and statistical quality — the rule-book the whole organization works under. In parallel it **establishes legal and regulatory compliance mechanisms** (07.2): identifying the applicable regulations (GDPR, official-statistics legislation, data-sharing agreements) and defining the procedures that keep every process within the law.

Build — embed the controls. The frameworks are made operational by **implementing data and metadata governance** (07.3): assigning the data-governance roles (owner, steward, custodian) and the processes for metadata creation, maintenance, and lineage tracking, so governance is wired into how the streams actually work rather than living only on paper.

Operate — assure continuously. With controls in place, VS-07 **monitors quality and compliance indicators** (07.4) — measuring process and output quality (accuracy, timeliness, comparability) and tracking compliance status on formal scorecards and dashboards — and periodically **audits, certifies, and reports compliance** (07.5): conducting internal and external audits, performing quality reviews, and documenting adherence, which produces the assurance that statistics can be trusted.

Improve — close the loop. Finally it **updates and improves the governance mechanisms** (07.6): incorporating feedback, regulatory changes, and lessons learned back into the policies and control frameworks — so governance evolves with the organization rather than ossifying.

Business process	What it produces
VS-07.1 Define Governance Frameworks and Policies	Governance charters and policies (data, metadata, ethics, confidentiality, quality)
VS-07.2 Establish Legal and Regulatory Compliance Mechanisms	Compliance procedures mapped to applicable regulation
VS-07.3 Implement Data and Metadata Governance	Assigned governance roles + metadata/lineage processes
VS-07.4 Monitor Quality and Compliance Indicators	Quality & compliance dashboards/scorecards
VS-07.5 Audit, Certify, and Report Compliance	Audit reports, certifications, assurance statements
VS-07.6 Update and Improve Governance Mechanisms	Revised policies and controls reflecting change

Capability Governance

VS-07 is itself a capability that must be **designed** (its frameworks and operating model), **built** (roles, tooling, dashboards — with VS-09), **operated** (continuous monitoring and periodic audit), and **improved** (07.6). Unlike a primary stream it runs **continuously and organization-wide**, not as a per-cycle production run, and it produces assurance rather than statistical data.

Key Performance Indicators

VS-07 monitors itself with the same discipline it imposes on the chain:

KPI	Description	Measurement
Policy coverage	Share of streams and data domains operating under current, approved policies	Per policy domain, annually
Audit findings closed on time	Percentage of audit findings remediated within their agreed deadline	Per audit cycle
Compliance incidents	Number of confidentiality, security, or legal incidents	Per quarter (target: zero)
Certification status	Certifications and peer-review assessments held and current (e.g. Code of Practice)	Annually
Metadata-governance compliance	Share of registered datasets meeting the SAF-P09 obligations	Per cycle, from the streams' compliance evidence (their §6.4)
Regulatory response time	Time from detection of a regulatory change to an updated policy being issued	Per change

Interactions, Services and Events

VS-07 offers governance and assurance as a service to every other stream.

Counterpart	VS-07 provides	VS-07 receives	Interaction / event
All primary streams (VS-01...06)	Frameworks, policies, data-governance roles, controls	Compliance evidence, quality indicators, audit findings (their §6.4)	"Compliance review", "Audit", "Policy update issued"
VS-08 Innovation	Compliance criteria a new method must meet	Requests to assess/approve new methods before production	"Method compliance assessment"
VS-09 Infrastructure	Security & continuity policy to enforce	Security posture and incident evidence	"Security/continuity review"
VS-10 Engagement	Transparency & accountability commitments	Stakeholder trust signals and complaints	"Transparency report"
External (regulators, public, peers)	Certification, assurance, transparency reports	Regulatory requirements and changes	"Certification", "Regulatory change"

Business Objects / Artefacts

VS-07 manages enabling artefacts, not data states: the **governance framework & policy set**, the **regulatory compliance register**, the **data-governance role assignments and metadata/lineage rules**, the **quality & compliance dashboards**, and the **audit/certification reports**. These are referenced by every stream. Each artefact has a designated owner and is version-managed across its lifecycle (SAF-P03): changes are tracked, prior versions remain identifiable, and obsolete policies and controls are formally retired.

Applying This to Your NSI

Maturity Assessment Checklist

- ☐ Do we have documented governance frameworks and policies covering data, metadata, ethics, confidentiality, and quality?
- ☐ Have we mapped applicable regulation (GDPR, statistics law) to concrete compliance procedures?
- ☐ Are data-governance roles (owner, steward, custodian) assigned and metadata/lineage processes in place?
- ☐ Do we monitor quality and compliance on dashboards, and audit/certify periodically?
- ☐ Is there a closed loop that feeds audit findings and regulatory change back into the frameworks?

Scenarios

Scenario A — A new regulation lands. A change to data-protection law is detected (07.2/07.6). VS-07 assesses the impact, updates the privacy and confidentiality policy, issues a "Policy update" to all streams, and verifies adoption at the next audit — the chain stays compliant without each stream interpreting the law independently.

Scenario B — Pre-production method approval. VS-08 proposes a new machine-learning coding method. VS-07 assesses it against the compliance criteria (privacy, transparency, quality) before VS-08's 08.5 transfer to production, certifies it, and records the decision — so only sound, compliant methods reach the production streams.

Scenario C — Preparing a Code of Practice peer review. Ahead of the periodic European Statistics Code of Practice peer review, VS-07 assembles the evidence base from its dashboards and the streams' compliance reporting (07.4/07.5): policy register, audit trail summaries, quality indicators, and incident records. Gaps surfaced by the self-assessment — say, an outdated revision policy — are remediated through 07.6 before the review. The peer-review outcome and its recommendations enter the governance backlog, and the resulting certification is published as external assurance.